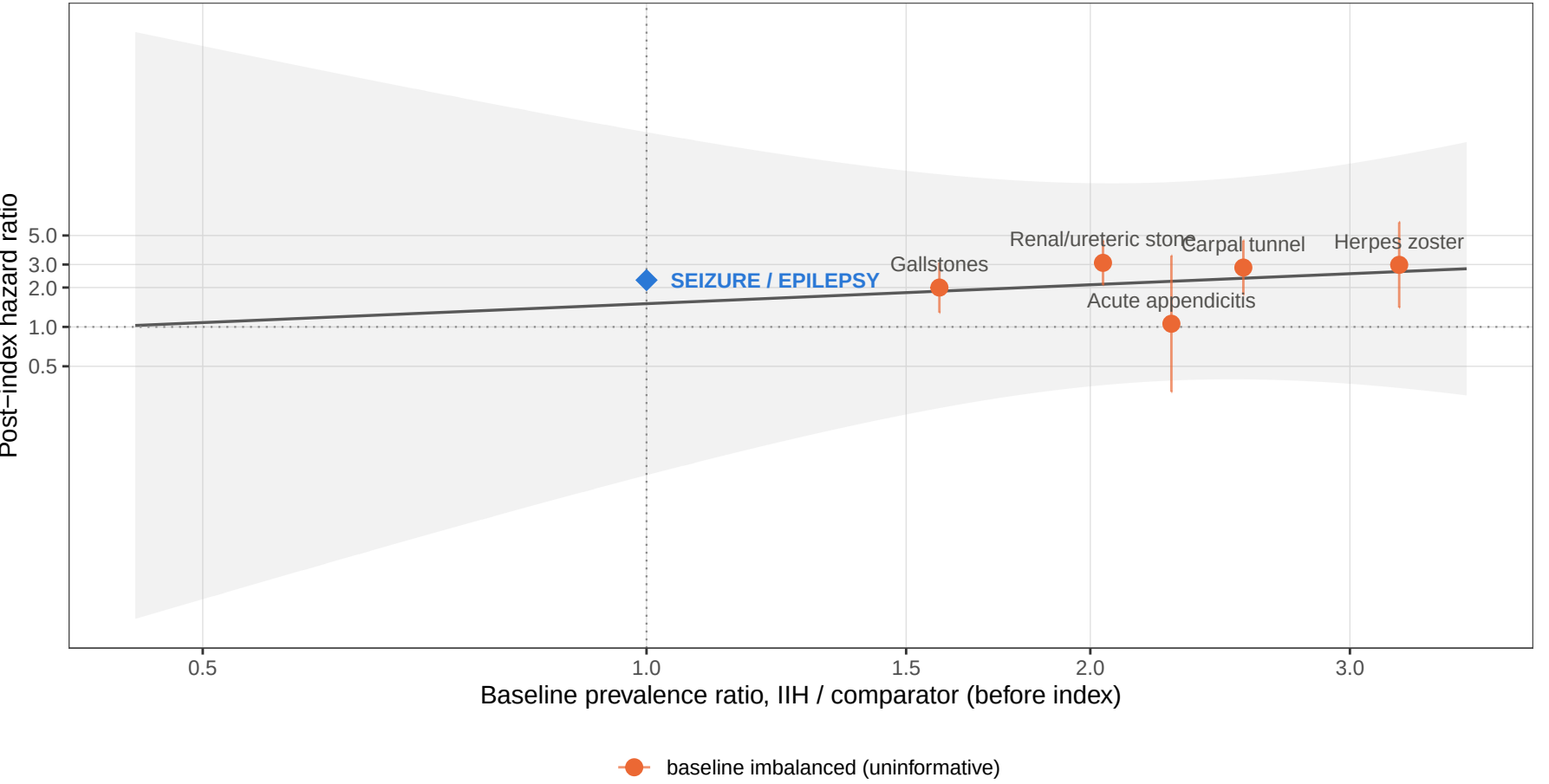


Baseline imbalance and apparent post-index effect, negative controls

Each point is an outcome with no plausible causal link to IIH. Both axes log scale.



Recomputed on the rebuilt matched cohort; the previously published version used the earlier, arm-asymmetric matching and does not carry over. THE CALIBRATION ARGUMENT DOES NOT SURVIVE THE REBUILD. Across five estimable controls the relationship between baseline imbalance and apparent effect is weak and not significant ($r = 0.28$, $p = 0.65$; slope 0.48, SE 0.94), so the predicted detection-only hazard ratio at baseline balance is 1.51 with a useless interval (0.07 to 30.8). Five of six controls are imbalanced at baseline and so cannot inform specificity at all; the one balanced control, limb fracture, has too few events to estimate. Several controls sit at hazard ratios of 2.0 to 3.1, close to the seizure estimate itself. This panel should be read as evidence that the negative-control approach cannot adjudicate specificity in these data, not as support for the primary result.